

Promotion Justification — DRAFT FOR REVIEW

⚠ Items flagged [NEEDS INPUT] require Glenn's confirmation or HR data before final submission.

Header

Promotional Candidate Name: Glenn N. Heistand, P.E., CFM, BC.WRE

Current Title: Associate Research Scientist, Water Resources Engineer

Proposed Title: Principal Research Scientist, Water Resources Engineering

Working Title: Head, Coordinated Hazard Assessment and Mapping Program (CHAMP)

Percent on GRF: ~83% [NEEDS INPUT — confirm current FY allocation from PRIDE/budget]

On a current NONR? [NEEDS INPUT — confirm with HR/Jenna Shelton]

Supervisor's name: Jenna Shelton, Illinois State Water Survey Director [NEEDS INPUT — confirm correct supervisor for this submission]

Survey/Group: Illinois State Water Survey, Coordinated Hazard Assessment and Mapping Program (CHAMP)

Date last hired/promoted in current position: June 1, 2021 (*Appointed Head, CHAMP / promoted to Associate Research Scientist effective April–June 2021; date of record: June 1, 2021*)

Does the employee have three consecutive positive performance evaluations? Yes [NEEDS INPUT — confirm evaluations are on file for FY2022, FY2023, FY2024; third must be complete before February of promotion year]

Justification submitted by: [NEEDS INPUT — typically the supervisor (Jenna Shelton) or a designee; Glenn may draft, but submission line should reflect submitter]

Section 1: Statement of Request for Promotion and Summary of Degree and Years of Experience

The Prairie Research Institute (PRI) and the Illinois State Water Survey (ISWS) are seeking a promotion for Glenn N. Heistand, P.E., CFM, BC.WRE to Principal Research Scientist, Water Resources Engineering.

Glenn holds a Master of Science in Environmental Engineering (Civil Engineering concentration) from the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (2017) and a Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering from Ohio Northern University (1995). He is a licensed Professional Engineer (P.E.) in Illinois, Ohio, and Maryland; a Certified Floodplain Manager (CFM) through the Association of State Floodplain Managers (ASFPM); and a Board Certified Water Resources Engineer (BC.WRE) through the American Society of Civil Engineers (ASCE). These credentials collectively reflect the highest levels of professional recognition available in his field.

Glenn has over 30 years of professional experience in water resources engineering, regulatory floodplain management, and federal grant program administration. He has been a member of the ISWS staff since November 2009, initially serving as Senior Hydraulic Engineer within CHAMP. In April–June 2021, he was appointed Head of the Coordinated Hazard Assessment and Mapping Program and promoted to Associate Research Scientist — a role that substantially expanded his scope of responsibility from senior technical contributor to program director, section leader, and institutional representative.

Since June 2021, Glenn has led CHAMP as a federally funded program office managing approximately \$15.4 million in active FEMA/DHS cooperative agreements and state partnerships, supervising a team of approximately 27 professional staff, and representing ISWS and PRI at the national level through appointments to federal advisory councils. He brings more than 16 years of cumulative ISWS experience and more than 5 years in his current role as Section Head and Associate Research Scientist.

Section 2: Why the Individual Should Receive a Promotion Compared to the Framework and Criteria of the Promotional Plan

Experience and Expanded Responsibilities

Glenn Heistand's promotion to Principal Research Scientist is justified by a sustained, substantial expansion of responsibilities that clearly exceeds the scope of the Associate Research Scientist level. His current duties encompass:

Program Direction and Financial Oversight: Glenn serves as Principal Investigator (PI) and program director for CHAMP, Illinois' premier FEMA Cooperating Technical Partners (CTP) program. Active grant awards under his directorship currently total approximately \$15.4 million, including: - DHS EMC-2023-CA-05003: \$4,908,602 (September 2023–October 2027) - DHS EMC-2022-CA-00011: \$3,303,700 (September 2022–August 2026) - DHS EMC-2021-CA-00012: \$3,250,000 (September 2021–September 2026) - DHS EMC-2024-CA-05002: \$3,241,000 (September 2024–September 2028) - Multiple state and sub-award contracts through IDNR and local entities

He secures, manages, and reports on this portfolio in compliance with federal grant regulations, maintains program performance benchmarks required by FEMA, and is accountable to FEMA, ISWS, and PRI leadership for all programmatic outcomes.

Staff Leadership and Supervision: As Section Head, Glenn directly leads a 27-person multidisciplinary team of engineers, GIS specialists, project managers, and outreach professionals. His supervisory responsibilities include performance evaluations, merit decisions, recruitment, and professional development planning for all CHAMP staff. He has successfully built and retained a high-performing team over a multi-year period spanning significant staffing growth.

Federal Advisory and Policy Leadership: Glenn was appointed in 2024 to serve as an Illinois representative on FEMA's Technical Mapping Advisory Council (TMAC), a federal advisory committee that advises the FEMA Administrator on the implementation of the National Flood Insurance Program (NFIP) and the national flood mapping program. He also serves as a member of the DHS Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) Levee Subsector Council. These appointments represent national recognition of his expertise and position him — and by extension ISWS — as an authoritative voice in national flood risk policy.

Strategic and Institutional Leadership: Glenn serves as a member of the ISWS Senior Leadership Team and co-chairs the Illinois Integrated Water Information Center (IIWIC) Initiative, a joint ISWS/IDNR effort to develop a statewide water data integration strategy. He is a member of the Illinois State Water Plan Task Force and contributes to statewide water resources policy development. He also serves on ISWS and PRI internal committees including the Promotion Review Committee, the Data Management Committee, and the DEI Committee.

Innovation Leadership: Glenn established and leads the CHAMP AI Workgroup, which develops practical AI adoption strategies for flood risk mapping workflows, including custom GPT-based expert systems for FEMA guideline interpretation, Python automation that reduced quarterly reporting time by approximately 50%, and staff training on responsible AI tool use. He was appointed to the PRI AI Research Frontier Committee and is driving AI integration at both the program and institute levels.

Professional Development

Glenn maintains active engagement with the national water resources and floodplain management professional community. He served as Chair of the Association of State Floodplain Managers (ASFPM) from 2022–2024, having previously served as Secretary (2021–2022) and Treasurer (2019–2021). He currently co-chairs the ASFPM Mapping and Engineering Standards Committee. He has held leadership positions in the Illinois

Association for Floodplain and Stormwater Management (IAFSM) for over a decade, including Past Chair, Chair, Vice Chair, Treasurer, and Secretary.

In 2023, Glenn completed the Leading Edge Leadership Certificate Program at Parkland College, comprising 44 hours of professional development in leadership, coaching, communication, and organizational effectiveness. He received the PRI Outstanding Collaboration Award in 2023.

Glenn holds an Affiliate Researcher appointment in the Water Resources Engineering and Science (WRES) group at the Grainger College of Engineering, University of Illinois, facilitating applied research collaboration between ISWS and UIUC.

Publications and Service Deliverables

Glenn's scholarly and technical contributions include:

- *An Assessment of the Impacts of Climate Change on Cultural Heritage in Illinois* (2024), Illinois State Archaeological Survey/PRI
- *Illinois State Water Plan* (2022), Illinois Department of Natural Resources
- *Structure-Specific Flood Risk Assessment Studies* (2019), CHAMP/ISWS
- *StormStore Feasibility Report* (2017), ISWS
- *Stormwater Volume Trading Analysis* (2017), ISWS
- *Urban Flooding Awareness Act Report* (2015), ISWS
- *The Conundrum of Unsteady Flow in a Regulatory Setting* (2013), ASFPM Proceedings

He has also directed the production of over 34 FEMA-compliant flood study technical reports and associated mapping deliverables across 25+ Illinois counties under CHAMP, including Flood Insurance Rate Maps (FIRMs), Flood Insurance Study (FIS) reports, and supporting hydrologic and hydraulic (H&H) engineering products.

Public speaking (selected, 2025): - Keynote, Connecticut Association of Flood Managers (CAFM) Annual Conference, Hartford, CT, November 2025: *Third Party Mapping and Other National Flood Topics* - Invited Panelist, Fathom Webinar, October 2025: *Navigating the Future of Flood Mapping: A Hybrid Model for a Fuller View of Risk* - Invited Panelist, NAFSMA Webinar, October 2025: *Flood Risk Data vs. Regulatory Maps*

[NEEDS INPUT — Glenn should provide any additional conference presentations, peer-reviewed articles, or technical reports not listed above]

Expert Witness and Legal Services

Glenn has served as an expert witness in hydrologic and hydraulic engineering matters, including *OH DOT vs. Price* and *Huspen vs. Cooper* (2007), and has provided technical regulatory review services for development and permitting clients through BaseFlood

Engineering, PLLC (2022–present). [NEEDS INPUT — confirm whether this private-sector work is appropriate to highlight in the PRI/ISWS context, given conflict-of-interest considerations]

Section 3: Promotional Track Placement and Criteria

Per PRI's academic professional promotion policy and the scientific track framework, the established promotion path from Associate Research Scientist is to Principal Research Scientist, requiring a minimum of four years in the current role (Associate Research Scientist) and a demonstrated record of expanded responsibilities, leadership, and professional achievement.

Glenn clearly meets and exceeds these criteria:

Eligibility: Glenn has served as Associate Research Scientist and Section Head since June 2021 — approximately five years as of the anticipated effective date of February 16, 2027. He has received three or more consecutive positive performance evaluations.

Expansion of Responsibility: Glenn's role as Head of CHAMP is by any measure a Principal Research Scientist-level position. He independently leads a major program office, administers a \$15.4M active grant portfolio, directs a 27-person professional staff, and represents ISWS before FEMA and DHS at the federal advisory level. The scope of his financial oversight, institutional representation, and programmatic leadership exceeds what is typically expected of an Associate Research Scientist.

Competencies and Characteristic Contributions:

Experience and Professional Development: 30+ years in water resources engineering; M.S. Environmental Engineering (UIUC, 2017); P.E. (IL, OH, MD); CFM; BC.WRE; completed leadership development certificate (Parkland College, 2023); FEMA TMAC appointee.

Publications and Scholarship: Seven published reports and articles; lead or co-lead on 34+ FEMA flood study deliverables across Illinois; statewide policy documents including the 2022 Illinois State Water Plan.

Mentoring and Supervision: Direct supervision and professional development of 27 CHAMP staff members across engineering, GIS, and outreach functions; served on promotion review committees at ISWS and PRI; internal training and education programs for CHAMP staff on FEMA compliance, AI tools, and technical methods.

Leadership: Current Head of CHAMP (PI); ISWS Senior Leadership Team member; FEMA TMAC appointee; DHS-CISA Levee Subsector Council member; ASFPM Chair (2022–2024); IAFSM leadership for 12+ years; IIWIC Co-Chair; PRI AI Research Frontier Committee; Affiliate Researcher, UIUC.

External Funding: PI/program director for \$15.4M in active federal and state grants; responsible for renewal and maintenance of CHAMP's FEMA CTP program cooperative agreements; secured program funding stability through 2028.

Service and Core Research: Member, Illinois State Water Plan Task Force; ISWS Promotion Review Committee; ISWS Data Management Committee; ISWS/PRI DEI Committee; ASFPM Mapping and Engineering Standards Committee (co-chair); IAFSM (past leadership).

Engagement and Outreach: National and state conference presentations; keynote speaker (CAFM 2025); invited panelist (Fathom, NAFSMA 2025); CHAMP annual retreat presentations; ISWS Open House; public outreach on flood risk and FEMA mapping.

Glenn Heistand is currently operating at, and in many respects beyond, the level of a Principal Research Scientist. His promotion represents a formal recognition of the responsibilities he has carried since 2021.

Section 4: Summary

Glenn Heistand is highly qualified and overdue for promotion to Principal Research Scientist, Water Resources Engineering. With over 30 years of professional experience, 16+ years at ISWS, and five years directing CHAMP at the section head level, he represents one of ISWS's most senior and impactful academic professionals.

Under his leadership, CHAMP has grown into a nationally recognized flood risk program managing over \$15 million in active federal grants, employing nearly 30 professional staff, and contributing directly to FEMA's national flood mapping mission across Illinois. His appointment to FEMA's Technical Mapping Advisory Council and the DHS-CISA Levee Subsector Council are among the most prestigious appointments available to professionals in his field and bring significant recognition and visibility to PRI and ISWS.

His national leadership through ASFPM (Chair, 2022–2024), his IIWIC co-chairmanship, his pioneering work on AI integration in flood risk mapping, and his Affiliate Researcher appointment at UIUC demonstrate that Glenn has independently advanced the research and service mission of ISWS well beyond the expectations of his current classification.

A promotion to Principal Research Scientist, Water Resources Engineering is both warranted and appropriate, providing Glenn the institutional recognition that matches his actual responsibilities, tenure, and national standing.

Section 5: Comparison of Other Employees in the Same Title and Section

There are currently three employees in the Associate Research Scientist classification within CHAMP/ISWS who serve as a peer comparison group:

Name	Current Title	In Current Role Since	Years in Role
Glenn Heistand	Associate Research Scientist, Water Resources Engineer	June 1, 2021	~5 years
Christopher Hanstad	Associate Research Scientist	July 16, 2022	~4 years
Gregory Byard	Associate Research Scientist	March 16, 2024	~2 years

There are currently **no Principal Research Scientists within CHAMP or the broader CHAMP-adjacent sections of ISWS**. Glenn has significantly more time in role than his ARS peers and is the only ARS currently performing section-head, program-PI, and federal advisory responsibilities. A promotion to Principal Research Scientist will formally recognize the expanded role and responsibilities Glenn has carried since 2021 and is consistent with his peers in similar leadership roles across PRI and ISWS.

[NEEDS INPUT — HR: Are there Principal Research Scientists in other ISWS sections that should be included for comparison? What are their current salaries? See Section 6.]

Section 6: Salary Comparison at Proposed Title

[NEEDS INPUT — HR data required for this section.]

Glenn's current annual salary is \$120,340. The standard promotion increment to Principal Research Scientist would bring his salary to approximately \$[X].

Based on the Zhang promotion package (October 2025), PRI Principal Research Scientists in comparable sections have a median salary of approximately \$124,526 and an average of approximately \$121,512. Given that Glenn is already compensated near this range due to the section head responsibilities he has carried since 2021, the promotion primarily represents a title and classification alignment rather than a large salary adjustment.

Equity Consideration: If there is a pay disparity between Glenn's current salary and the appropriate range for a Principal Research Scientist with section-head responsibilities, an

equity request may be appropriate. This should be evaluated against other Section Heads and Principal Research Scientists across PRI surveys.

[NEEDS INPUT — Glenn / Jenna Shelton: Should an equity request accompany this promotion? HR comparison data needed.]

Section 7: Organizational Chart

(Organizational chart should be exported from the CHAMP Staff Plan in the CHAMP-PM application)

Current structure (as of June 2026):

Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research & Innovation (OVCRI) – Susan A. Martinis → Prairie Research Institute (PRI) Director – Praveen Kumar → Illinois State Water Survey (ISWS) Director – Jenna Shelton → **Coordinated Hazard Assessment and Mapping Program (CHAMP)** → **Section Head – Glenn Heistand** (*proposed: Principal Research Scientist, Water Resources Engineering*) → Senior Staff (3 Associate Research Scientists, 10 Assistant Research Scientists, 6 Senior Scientific Specialists, 6 Scientific Specialists, support staff)

This is a promotional title change and reclassification; no organizational restructuring is proposed.

[NEEDS INPUT — Export current org chart from CHAMP Staff Plan for attachment]

Flags and Items Requiring Input Before Submission

#	Item	Who	Notes
1	Confirm current GRF % allocation	Glenn + PRIDE	Memory suggests ~83% GRF; verify current FY
2	NONR status	HR / Jenna Shelton	Unknown — check if on NONR
3	Confirm submitter name/ title	Glenn + Jenna Shelton	Template requires supervisor as submitter
4	Confirm 3 consecutive positive evals on file	HR / Glenn	Confirm FY2022, FY2023, FY2024 evals complete
5	Additional publications / presentations	Glenn	Any peer-reviewed articles, conference abstracts, other technical reports not listed
6		HR	

#	Item	Who	Notes
	HR salary data for Principal Research Scientists		Needed for Section 6; comparable PRI/ISWS positions
7	Equity request decision	Glenn + Jenna	Does pay disparity justify equity request alongside promotion?
8	Org chart export	Glenn	Export from CHAMP Staff Plan (CHAMP-PM app)
9	BaseFlood Engineering reference	Glenn	Confirm whether private practice is appropriate to highlight in PRI promotion materials
10	Proposed effective date confirmation	HR	Standard is February 16; confirm for 2027 cycle